Daiwei Chen

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Research Interests

LLM Post-Training · Reward Modeling · AI Safety & Alignment · LLM Factuality · Generative Recommendation

Education

University of Wisconsin-Madison — Madison, WI
Ph.D. in Electrical and Computer Engineering — *Sep 2023 – Present*

University of Pennsylvania — Philadelphia, PA
M.S. in Systems Engineering — *Aug 2021 – May 2023*

Zhejiang University — Hangzhou, China
B.S. in Psychology — *Sep 2017 – Jun 2021*

Work Experience

LinkedIn — Mountain View, CA

Responsible AI - Research Intern — Jun 2026 – Sep 2026

- Resolved The Alignment Tax Issue in LLM post-training through **Multi-Teacher On-Policy Distillation** (MOPD).

Generative AI - Research Intern — May 2025 – Aug 2025

- Developed **GTI** for LLM-Based Generative Recommendation, improving candidate-retrieval Precision@5 by 21.6%.

Publications

[1] **GTI: Grounded Token Initialization for New Vocabulary in LMs for Generative Recommendation**
D. Chen, Z. Fu, C. Jiang, H. Zhang, R. Zhou, T. Wang, C. Yao, G. Li, R. Cai, Y. Cao, R. Jiang, F. Borisyuk, J. Shen, J. Wu, R. K. Vinayak
EMNLP 2026 *Main Conference*

[2] **Compositional Self-Improvement**
C. Shin, D. Chen, J. Cooper, B. Lake, F. Sala, R. K. Vinayak
ICML 2026 *– 2nd Workshop on Compositional Learning: Safety, Interpretability, and Agents*

[3] **LinkedOut: Linking World Knowledge Representation Out of Video LLM for Next-Generation Video Recommendation**
H. Zhang, Y. Lu, L. Wang, Y. Li, D. Chen, Y. Xu, Y. Fu
Findings of CVPR, 2026

[4] **PAL: Sample-Efficient Personalized Reward Modeling for Pluralistic Alignment**
D. Chen, Y. Chen, A. Rege, Z. Wang, R. K. Vinayak
ICLR 2025 | *NeurIPS 2024 Workshop (**Spotlight**)* | *ICML 2024 Workshop (**Oral**)*

[5] **Unraveling the Impact of Training Samples**
D. Chen, J. Zhang, R. K. Vinayak
ICLR 2024 *– The Third Blogpost Track*

Manuscripts & Preprints

[6] **One Model, Many Modes: Evolving System Prompt Ensembles for Creative Generation**
D. Chen, A. He, B. Yao, J. Hu, R. K. Vinayak
Under review

[7] **Is Conformal Factuality for RAG-based LLMs Robust? Novel Metrics and Systematic Insights**
Y. Chen, D. Chen, S. M. Chikodikar, C. H. Yin, R. K. Vinayak
Under review | Preprint, arXiv:2603.16817, 2026

[8] **Learning Capacity: A Measure of the Effective Dimensionality of a Model**
D. Chen*, W.-K. Chang*, P. Chaudhari
arXiv:2305.17332, 2023 | ** Equal contribution.*

Service & Awards

Reviewer: NeurIPS 2026, ICLR 2026, CVPR 2026, EACL 2026, COLM 2026.

Teaching: Matrix Methods in ML, Data Science & Eng. (UW-Madison); Software Design, Statistics (UPenn).

Awards: Lambda.ai Research Grant Sponsorship (2025); UPenn Outstanding Research Award (2023); Zhejiang University Scholarship (2021).